T1 · TEACHER GUIDE

# Set up a class and share it

Create a class, mint group codes, and share them with students so they can join.

**Where this fits**

A **class** is the starting point for everything else. It holds your students (as anonymous groups, no personal accounts) and the activities you build for them. Do this once per class; it takes about three minutes. Afterwards, follow *T2 — Create your first activity*.

The **Getting started** card at the top of *Classes* ticks these steps off as you go and links each one to the right control — this guide is the same walk, written out.

## What a class is

In AIPLA a **class** is a container you own. It has:

- one or more **group codes** — the short codes students type to join. Students do not create accounts and do not log in; the group code is all they need.
- the **activities** you assign to it (guide *T2*).
- a **tutor** — who teaches this class: its name, picture, voice, tone and teaching approach, in one choice. Leave the default or change it later.

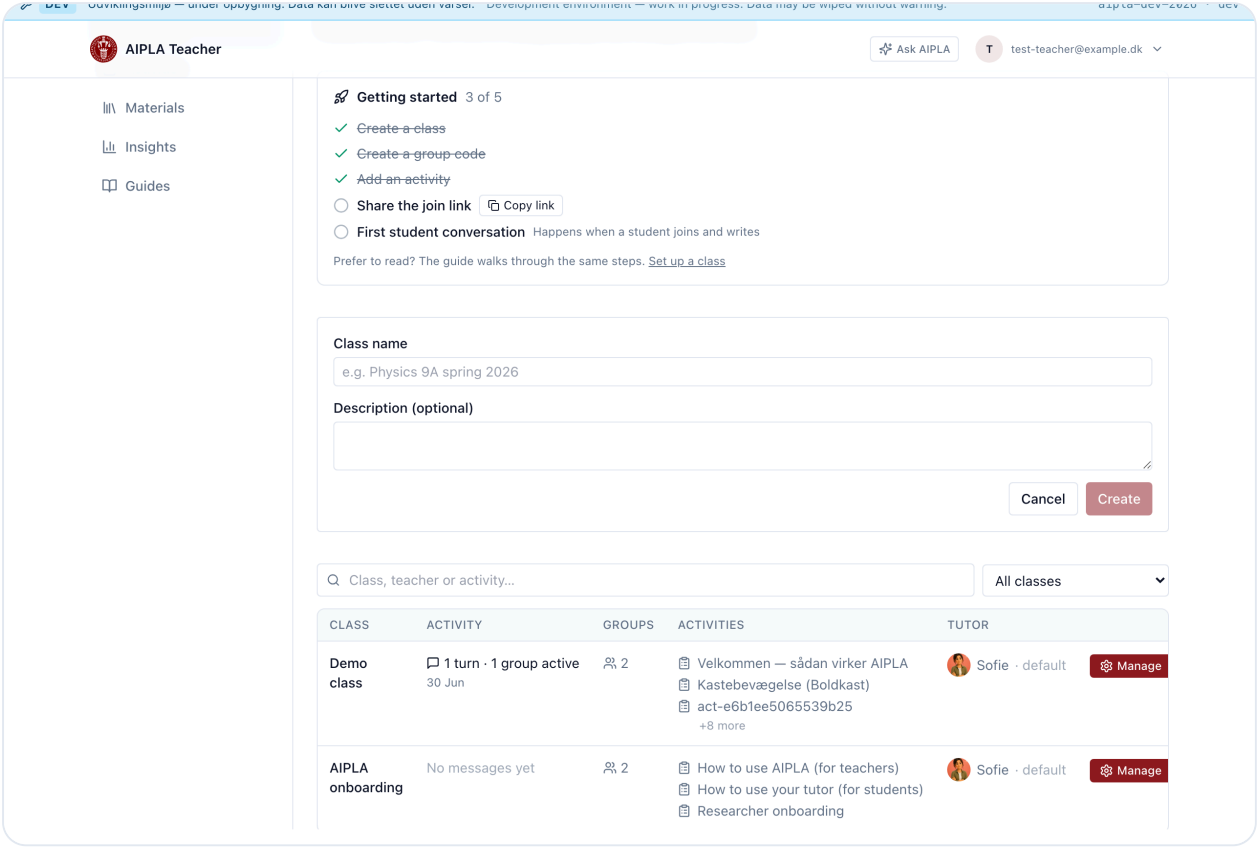
Everything below is done in your browser. You do not need a developer.

**The co-pilot can do this for you**

On *Classes*, click **Ask AIPLA** in the header and choose **Class co-pilot**. You can create a class and mint group codes by asking it in plain language, instead of using the forms below — see *T4 — Author with the AI co-pilot*.

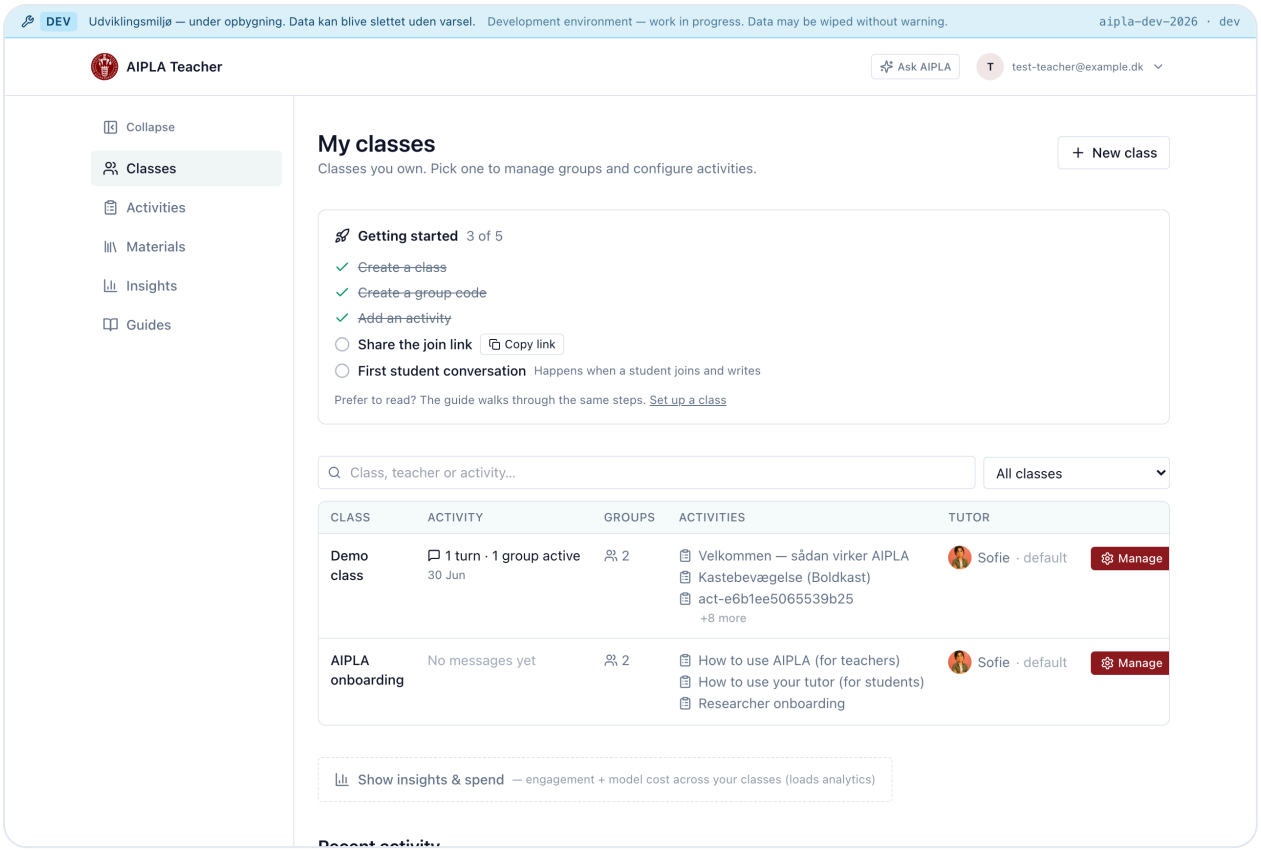
## Step 1 — Create the class

From your teacher area, open **Classes** and select **New class**. Give the class a **name** — for example, *"Physics 2.g, autumn 2026"* — and, optionally, a short description. Select **Create**.




The New class form: a name and an optional description.

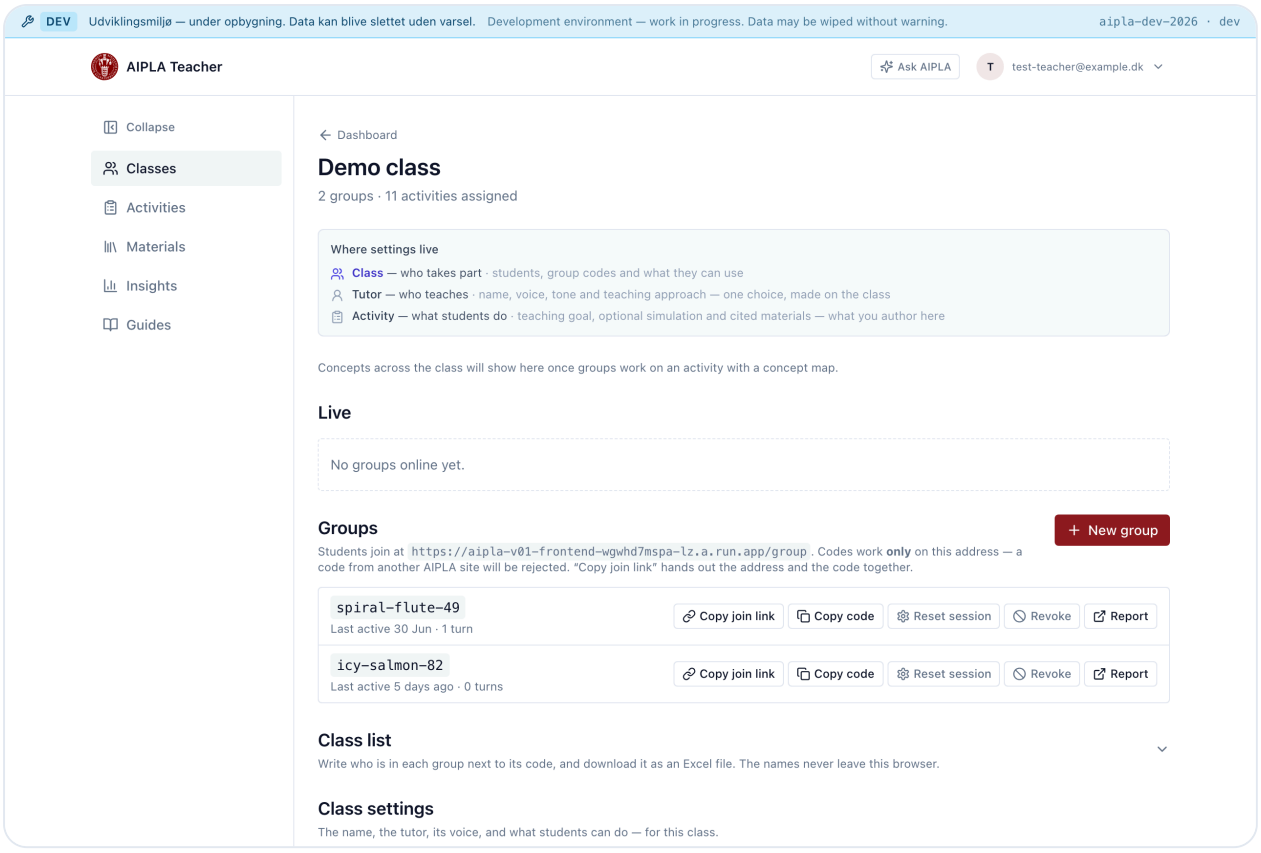
Your new class now appears in the class list, alongside any others you own.




The class list shows each class with its group codes, activities and tutor.

## Step 2 — Mint a group code

Open the class with **Manage**. A new class has no group codes yet, so select **New group**. AIPLA generates a short code and copies it to your clipboard.




Selecting New group mints a code students use to join.

You can mint more than one group code for the same class — for example, one per table group or per lab pair — so you can tell their work apart in reports.

## Step 3 — Share the code with students

Beside each code, select **Copy join link** and give students that link. It carries the address and the code together, so nobody lands on the wrong AIPLA site — a code works only on the site it was made on. (**Copy code** copies just the code, for students who are already on the right page.) They open the link and they are in — no login, no personal account (see *S1 — Join and use your tutor*). Anything they do is grouped under that code, so your class reports stay organised.

If you want to remember who is behind each code, open **Class list** on the class page: write the names next to each code and **Download as Excel**. The names stay in your browser on this device — AIPLA never receives them.

If a code leaks, select **Revoke** beside it. The code stops working at once and can never be reissued; the group's work is kept. Mint a new code for the group with **New group**.

> **Tip**
>
> Group codes are how you separate one class — or one lab group — from another in the reports. Mint a fresh code for each group you want to track separately.

## Step 4 — Choose the tutor (optional)

Under **Class settings** on the class page, **Tutor** sets who teaches every activity in this class — name, picture, voice, tone and teaching approach, in one choice. Leave it on the default, or pick another.

### Make your own tutor

Any teacher can write a teaching approach and build a tutor on it; you do not need a researcher account. Open the **Teaching approaches** link beside *Tutor* (or **Approaches** in the account menu, top right):

1. On the **Your approaches** tab, select **New approach**. Give it a **Name**, a **One-line summary**, and write **What the tutor is told** in full, as if briefing a teaching assistant. Select **Save**.
2. On the **Tutors** tab, select **New tutor**. Give it a **Name**, pick your approach under **Teaching approach** (your own approaches are listed after the seven published ones), choose a **Face and voice**, and select **Create tutor**. To change only the approach of an existing tutor, select the branch icon beside it (*Make a variant of …*) instead.
3. Back on the class page, pick your new tutor under **Tutor**.

The seven published approaches can be read on the **Approaches** tab but not changed — they are maintained by the research team.

## Next steps

- Build the first activity for this class — *T2 — Create your first activity*.
- Add curriculum documents the tutor can draw on — *T3 — Add and organise curriculum materials*.

Last reviewed: 2026-10-05 · AIPLA project team